A 48-qubit code with native CCZ

Boolean functions, projective geometry, and SAT

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Why a native CCZ gate

Fault-tolerant computation needs a non-Clifford logical gate. CCZ changes the sign of $|111\rangle$ only, and Clifford gates plus CCZ are universal.

Magic-state distillation

Standard method. Prepares noisy resource states and distills them, at a large space-time overhead.

Transversal gate

A code whose physical phase rotations implement the logical gate directly on the data block.

Target: a CSS code with $k = 3$ logical qubits and distance $d \geq 3$ whose logical CCZ is one layer of physical T or $T^\dagger$, one gate per data qubit, with no ancilla and no correction. We call such an implementation *native*. A single-qubit gate cannot spread one fault to two qubits.

Question: how short can a native CCZ code with $d \geq 3$ be?

Bravyi–Haah 2012 (distillation) Campbell–Howard 2017 (CSS codes with transversal CCZ).

This talk

Result. $Q_{48} = [\![48, 3, 3]\!]$: logical CCZ from one layer of $26\,T + 22\,T^\dagger$ on the data qubits. It is the shortest known code with a native CCZ and distance three.

1. **Boolean functions and codes.** Truth tables, polynomials, overlaps, and how degree bounds weight divisibility.
2. **The gate criterion.** Native CCZ is equivalent to parity, mod-4, and mod-8 conditions on overlap counts of rows.
3. **Construction of Q_{48}.** Stabilizer rows from projective geometry, logical rows from a SAT solver, signs from a linear system over $\mathbb{Z}_4$.
4. **Summary.** Known and open lengths.

The phase of a transversal diagonal gate depends only on weights of rows and of their products. Rows are Boolean functions.

Codewords are truth tables

A *Boolean function* $f\colon \mathbb{F}_2^3 \to \mathbb{F}_2$ is stored as its *truth table*: the 8-bit word of values at the addresses $u = 000, 001, \ldots, 111$.

function	truth table
1	`11111111`
u_1	`00001111`
u_2	`00110011`
u_3	`01010101`
$u_1 \oplus u_2 \oplus u_3$	`01101001`

Affine functions $f_{a,b}(u) = b \oplus a_1u_1 \oplus a_2u_2 \oplus a_3u_3$. Their 16 truth tables form the Reed–Muller code $\mathrm{RM}(1,3)$, the $[8,4,4]$ extended Hamming code. Its generator matrix has rows $1, u_1, u_2, u_3$ and one column per address u.

Every linear code has this form: each column is a point, each row is a function evaluated at the points.

Truth tables are polynomials

Every Boolean function is a unique XOR of products of distinct variables, its *algebraic normal form*. Its *degree* is the size of the largest product.

Products of functions are coordinatewise AND of truth tables, written $f \wedge g$:

$$u_1 \wedge u_2 = u_1 u_2 \iff 00001111 \wedge 00110011 = 00000011.$$

The indicator of the single point 000 has degree three:

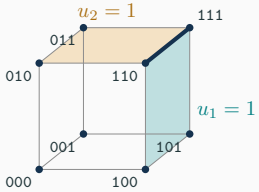
$$\delta_{000} = (1 \oplus u_1)(1 \oplus u_2)(1 \oplus u_3) = 1 \oplus u_1 \oplus u_2 \oplus u_3 \oplus u_1u_2 \oplus u_1u_3 \oplus u_2u_3 \oplus u_1u_2u_3.$$

$\mathrm{RM}(\ell, m)$ is the set of truth tables of degree at most ℓ on m variables.

In Q_{48}, the logical rows have degree two (slide 22) and the $T/T^\dagger$ pattern is a cubic polynomial (slide 23).

Overlaps count shared ones

The *weight* $|f|$ counts the ones in a truth table. The *overlap* of two rows is $|f \wedge g|$.



Colored faces: ones of u_1 and u_2. Dark edge: their overlap $u_1 u_2$.

$$|u_1| = 4, \quad |u_2| = 4, \quad |u_1 \wedge u_2| = 2.$$

XOR keeps the positions in exactly one support, so the common edge is removed twice:

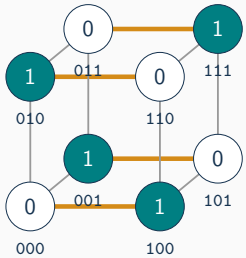
$$|f \oplus g| = |f| + |g| - 2|f \wedge g|,$$

$$|u_1 \oplus u_2| = 4 + 4 - 2 \cdot 2 = 4.$$

In QEC, an X row and a Z row commute exactly when their overlap is even.

$|f \oplus g|$ differs from $|f| + |g|$ by twice the overlap.

Nonconstant affine functions have weight 2^{m-1}



Parity $u_1 \oplus u_2 \oplus u_3$. Each gold edge changes u_1, and its endpoints have values 0 and 1.

Let f be nonconstant affine on m variables, and pick a variable u_i that appears in it. Toggling u_i flips the output.

2^{m-1} disjoint pairs, one 1 each $\implies |f| = 2^{m-1}$.

So $\mathrm{RM}(1, m)$ has weights 0, 2^{m-1}, 2^m only.

$m = 3$: weights $0, 4, 8$, so $d = 4$.
$m = 6$: 32 ones on 64 points (used for FG48).

Every weight in $\mathrm{RM}(1, m)$ is divisible by 2^{m-1}.

Low degree implies divisible weights

Theorem (McEliece, after Ax)

Every weight in $\mathrm{RM}(\ell, m)$ is divisible by $2^{\lceil m/\ell \rceil - 1}$.

code	divisor	weights
$\mathrm{RM}(1,4)$	8	$0, 8, 16$
$\mathrm{RM}(2,4)$	2	$0, 4, 6, 8, 10, 12, 16$
$\mathrm{RM}(2,6)$	4	$0, 16, 24, 28, 32, 36, 40, 48, 64$

For transversal T: $T^{\otimes n}$ multiplies a word c by $\omega^{|c|}$ with $\omega = e^{i\pi/4}$. A word whose weight is divisible by 8 gets phase 1.

Example. The 15-qubit code with transversal T has the $[15, 4, 8]$ simplex code as X stabilizers: columns are the 15 nonzero points of $\mathbb{F}_2^4$ (the projective space $\mathrm{PG}(3, 2)$), every nonzero weight is 8.

QEC objects as Boolean functions

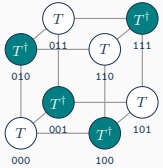
QEC object	Boolean-function object
physical qubit	point (column label)
row of S or K	function on the points
Hamming weight	number of ones
overlap of rows	weight of a product
X/Z commutation	overlap parity
phase of $T^{\otimes n}$	weight mod 8
whole column set	indicator function χ

For this project

- The stabilizer support is a projective space minus a subspace.
- The logical rows are degree-2 polynomials found by SAT.
- The $T/T^\dagger$ pattern is one cubic polynomial.

With the point set fixed, the logical rows are 144 unknown bits (slide 21), not a search over all binary matrices with 48 columns.

The eight-qubit cube code



Qubits at addresses $u \in \mathbb{F}_2^3$. White: $p(u) = 0$, apply T. Teal: $p(u) = 1$, apply $T^\dagger$.

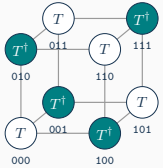
For $a \in \mathbb{F}_2^3$ let $f_a(u) = a_1u_1 \oplus a_2u_2 \oplus a_3u_3$.

$$|a\rangle_L = \tfrac{1}{\sqrt{2}}\big(|f_a\rangle + |f_a \oplus \texttt{11111111}\rangle\big).$$

Pattern: $p(u) = u_1 \oplus u_2 \oplus u_3$. With $\omega = e^{i\pi/4}$, a word v gets the phase $\omega^{\mathrm{sw}(v)}$,

$$\mathrm{sw}(v) = \#\{\text{ones at } T\} - \#\{\text{ones at } T^\dagger\} = |p \oplus v| - 4.$$

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$$\mathrm{sw}(v) = \#\{\text{ones at } T\} - \#\{\text{ones at } T^\dagger\} = |p \oplus v| - 4.$$

Per site, $(p \oplus v) - p$ equals v where $p = 0$ and $-v$ where $p = 1$. Every nonconstant affine function of three bits has exactly four ones (slide 6).

label	$p \oplus f_a$, $p \oplus f_a \oplus 1$	sw	phase
$a \neq 111$	nonconstant affine	$0,\ 0$	$+1$
$a = 111$	00000000, 11111111	$-4,\ +4$	$\omega^{\pm 4} = -1$

The cube code has distance two

Write Z_u for a phase flip on qubit u. On a word v, $Z_{000}Z_{100}$ gives the sign $(-1)^{v(000)\oplus v(100)}$. Both words of $|a\rangle_L$ give a_1, so

$$Z_{000}Z_{100}|a\rangle_L = (-1)^{a_1}|a\rangle_L.$$

The only X-type stabilizer is $X^{\otimes 8}$. It commutes with this weight-2 error, so the error is undetected and acts as a logical Z_1.

$$[\![8, 3, 2]\!], \qquad d_Z = 2, \quad d_X = 4.$$

Goal: transversal CCZ with $d_Z \geq 3$. This needs more qubits and a general criterion for the gate.

A CSS code as a binary matrix

$$G = \begin{bmatrix} K \\ S \end{bmatrix}, \qquad \mathcal{C}_2 = \operatorname{rowspan} S \subset \mathcal{C}_1 = \operatorname{rowspan} G.$$

The s rows of S are X-stabilizer generators, the 3 rows of K are X-logical generators, and the n columns are the physical qubits. The logical basis state with label $x \in \mathbb{F}_2^3$ is a coset sum:

$$|x_L\rangle = 2^{-s/2} \sum_{y \in \mathbb{F}_2^s} |K^\top x \oplus S^\top y\rangle.$$

Distances: $d_X = \min\{|c| : c \in \mathcal{C}_1 \setminus \mathcal{C}_2\}$ and $d_Z = \min\{|c| : c \in \mathcal{C}_2^\perp \setminus \mathcal{C}_1^\perp\}$, with $|c|$ the Hamming weight.

Cube code: $S = (11111111)$, and K has rows $u_1 = 00001111$, $u_2 = 00110011$, $u_3 = 01010101$.

Native CCZ as a phase condition

A pattern $\Gamma \in \{\pm 1\}^n$ applies T where $\Gamma_j = +1$ and $T^\dagger$ where $\Gamma_j = -1$. A basis word c gets the phase $\omega^{\mathrm{sw}_\Gamma(c)}$, with

$$\omega = e^{i\pi/4}, \qquad \mathrm{sw}_\Gamma(c) = \sum_j \Gamma_j c_j \quad \text{(signed weight)}.$$

Native CCZ condition: for every logical label x and stabilizer label y,

$$\mathrm{sw}_\Gamma\big(K^\top x \oplus S^\top y\big) \equiv 4x_1x_2x_3 \pmod 8.$$

requirement	reason
phase independent of y	all terms of one coset sum must keep their relative phase
phase equal to $(-1)^{x_1x_2x_3}$	the logical action must be CCZ

Signed weight of an XOR in terms of overlaps

Slide 5 gave the pair rule. Applied twice, at each coordinate as integers,

$$a \oplus b \oplus c = a + b + c - 2(a \wedge b + a \wedge c + b \wedge c) + 4\, a \wedge b \wedge c.$$

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In general, an XOR of m rows expands with coefficient $(-2)^{t-1}$ on each t-fold product. The signed weight sw_Γ is a weighted sum of coordinates, so the same identity holds for sw_Γ:

$$\mathrm{sw}_\Gamma(a \oplus b \oplus c) = \textstyle\sum_{\text{rows}} \mathrm{sw}_\Gamma(a) - 2 \sum_{\text{pairs}} \mathrm{sw}_\Gamma(a \wedge b) + 4\ \mathrm{sw}_\Gamma(a \wedge b \wedge c).$$

Products of four or more rows have coefficients divisible by 8 and vanish mod 8.

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Check: supports $\{1,2\}, \{2,3\}, \{2,4\}$ have weights 2, pair overlaps 1, triple overlap 1: $|a \oplus b \oplus c| = 6 - 2(3) + 4 = 4$.

Native criterion in signed overlaps

A codeword $K^\top x \oplus S^\top y$ is the XOR of the rows g selected by (x, y). Matching coefficients of 1, -2, and 4 against $4x_1x_2x_3$ gives:

Native criterion (paper, Prop. signed overlaps)

Γ implements CCZ natively if and only if, for distinct rows g, g', g'' of G,

$$\begin{aligned} \mathrm{sw}_\Gamma(g) &\equiv 0 \pmod 8, \\ \mathrm{sw}_\Gamma(g \wedge g') &\equiv 0 \pmod 4, \\ \mathrm{sw}_\Gamma(g \wedge g' \wedge g'') &\equiv \begin{cases} 1 \pmod 2, & \{g, g', g''\} = \{K_1, K_2, K_3\}, \\ 0 \pmod 2, & \text{otherwise.} \end{cases} \end{aligned}$$

In the cube code, $\Gamma = (-1)^p$ meets all three, with the logical triple $u_1 \wedge u_2 \wedge u_3$ at the single site 111.

Quasi-transversal versus native

Quasi-transversal: apply $T^{\otimes n}$, then a diagonal Clifford correction built from $P = \mathrm{diag}(1, i)$ and CZ gates. Campbell and Howard give nine parity conditions on G that suffice. Hu, Liang, and Calderbank show they are also necessary:

logical rows	mixed	stabilizer rows
K1: $\lvert K_i \rvert$ even	KS1: $\lvert K_i \wedge S_l \rvert$ even	S1: $\lvert S_l \rvert$ even
K2: $\lvert K_i \wedge K_{i'} \rvert$ even	KS2: $\lvert K_i \wedge K_{i'} \wedge S_l \rvert$ even	S2: $\lvert S_l \wedge S_{l'} \rvert$ even
K3: $\lvert K_1 \wedge K_2 \wedge K_3 \rvert$ **odd**	KS3: $\lvert K_i \wedge S_l \wedge S_{l'} \rvert$ even	S3: $\lvert S_l \wedge S_{l'} \wedge S_{l''} \rvert$ even

Native is the special case whose correction is $P^\dagger$ on single qubits, since $TP^\dagger = T^\dagger$. So every native code meets the nine conditions. The converse fails (slide 25).

Index ranges?

The column indicator encodes all overlap parities

Let G have r rows and distinct columns. Its *column indicator* $\chi_G\colon \mathbb{F}_2^r \to \mathbb{F}_2$ equals 1 exactly on the columns of G. For a test polynomial m in the row variables $z_1, \dots, z_r$,

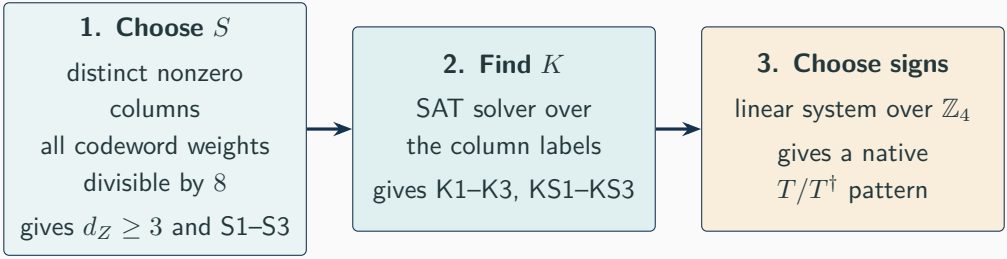
$$\langle \chi_G, m \rangle = \sum_{\text{columns } z} m(z) \pmod 2.$$

test polynomial m	$\langle \chi_G, m \rangle$ is the parity of
z_i	the weight of row i
$z_i z_j$	the overlap of rows i and j
$z_i z_j z_l$	the triple overlap of rows i, j, l

The nine conditions prescribe $\langle \chi_G, m \rangle$ for every monomial of degree 1 to 3.

With distinct columns, G is determined by its column set, and the nine conditions are conditions on χ_G (Nezami–Haah).

The construction runs in three steps



Each step fixes one group of conditions and leaves earlier choices unchanged.

Step 1 alone gives $d_Z \geq 3$. Steps 2 and 3 do not check distance.

Distinct nonzero columns give $d_Z \geq 3$

Column j of S is the syndrome $\beta_j \in \mathbb{F}_2^s$ of a Z error on qubit j. A Z error v of weight at most two has syndrome

$$Sv = \beta_j \qquad \text{or} \qquad Sv = \beta_i \oplus \beta_j.$$

If the columns are distinct and nonzero, both are nonzero: every such error is detected, whatever K is.

Such a column set is a set of points of the *projective space* $\mathrm{PG}(s-1, 2)$, the $2^s - 1$ nonzero vectors of $\mathbb{F}_2^s$. The code $\mathcal{C}_2$ is then called *projective*.

Cube code: $s = 1$ and all eight columns equal 1. The pair $\{000, 100\}$ has syndrome $1 \oplus 1 = 0$, which is the distance-2 error of slide 10.

Projective S gives $d_Z \geq 3$ for every choice of logical rows.

Weights are read from hyperplane sections

Call $\mathcal{C}_2$ *8-divisible* if every codeword weight is a multiple of 8. Then S1–S3 hold:

$$|a| \equiv 0 \ (8) \ \Rightarrow \ |a \wedge b| \equiv 0 \ (4) \ \Rightarrow \ |a \wedge b \wedge c| \equiv 0 \ (2),$$

using the pair and triple identities of slides 5 and 13 on $|a \oplus b|$ and $|a \oplus b \oplus c|$.

Choose a point set X whose hyperplane sections all have sizes $\equiv |X| \pmod 8$.

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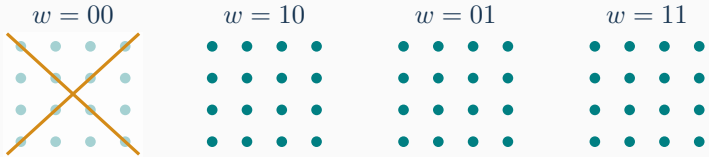
A nonzero $a \in \mathbb{F}_2^s$ gives the codeword $c_a = a^\top S$ with entries $c_a(j) = a \cdot \beta_j$. Let X be the column set and $H_a = \{\beta \neq 0 : a \cdot \beta = 0\}$, a hyperplane. Then

$$|c_a| = |X| - |X \cap H_a|.$$

Choose a point set X whose hyperplane sections all have sizes $\equiv |X| \pmod 8$.

FG48: projective space minus a solid

Write $\beta = (u, w) \in \mathbb{F}_2^4 \times \mathbb{F}_2^2$. Remove the 15 nonzero points with $w = 00$, a solid $\mathrm{PG}(3, 2)$:

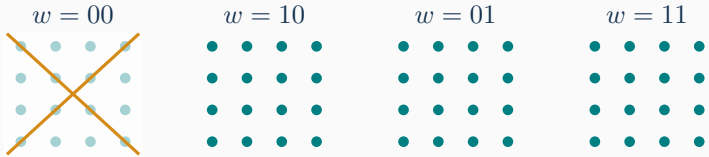


$63 - 15 = 48$ columns, $s = 6$. The rows of S are the coordinate functions $u_1, \ldots, u_4, w_1, w_2$.

Why only weights 24 and 32?

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A linear form $\ell(u, w) = \lambda \cdot u \oplus \mu \cdot w$ has weight

$$\lambda \neq 0 : \ 3 \cdot 8 = 24, \qquad \lambda = 0, \ \mu \neq 0 : \ 2 \cdot 16 = 32.$$

FG48 is projective and 8-divisible. Up to coordinate permutation it is the only projective 8-divisible $[48, 6]$ code.

Why only weights 24 and 32?

Logical rows by SAT

Unknowns: a logical label $\alpha_j \in \mathbb{F}_2^3$ for each column j, the jth column of K.

Already settled by S

- $d_Z \geq 3$ for every labeling
- S1–S3 constrain no label

Left for the solver

- K1, K2, K3: 7 parities
- KS1, KS2: $6s$ parities
- KS3: $3\binom{s}{2}$ parities

Each condition is a parity of products of label bits, of degree at most three. For FG48 ($n = 48$, $s = 6$):

$3n = 144$ Boolean variables, $\quad 7 + 6s + 3\binom{s}{2} = 88$ constraints, no distance constraint.

The logical rows of Q_{48}

On each block, the three logical rows are Boolean polynomials in $u = (u_1, u_2, u_3, u_4)$:

	$w = 10$	$w = 01$	$w = 11$
K_1	$u_1 \oplus u_3$	$1 \oplus u_3$	u_4
K_2	$1 \oplus u_1 \oplus u_2 \oplus u_3 \oplus u_4$	$1 \oplus u_1 \oplus u_3 \oplus u_1u_3 \oplus u_1u_4$	$u_3 \oplus u_4 \oplus u_1u_3 \oplus u_1u_4$
K_3	$1 \oplus u_1 \oplus u_1u_2 \oplus u_1u_4 \oplus u_3u_4$	$u_1 \oplus u_1u_2 \oplus u_2u_3 \oplus u_2u_4 \oplus u_3u_4$	$u_1 \oplus u_3 \oplus u_1u_4 \oplus u_2u_3 \oplus u_2u_4$

Degree at most two on each block. The eight labels x give eight disjoint cosets $K^\top x \oplus \mathcal{C}_2$.

$K_1 \wedge K_2 \wedge K_3$ has odd weight (K3). Every other overlap parity is even.

Signs from a linear system over $\mathbb{Z}_4$

Write $\Gamma_j = 1 - 2\gamma_j$ with $\gamma_j \in \{0, 1\}$ marking $T^\dagger$. Then $\mathrm{sw}_\Gamma(c) = |c| - 2\,\gamma \cdot c$, and native CCZ becomes

$$\gamma \cdot c \equiv \tfrac{1}{2}|c| - 2x_1x_2x_3 \pmod 4 \qquad \text{for every codeword } c = K^\top x \oplus S^\top y.$$

For Q_{48}, a solution is $\gamma(u, w) = u_3 \oplus w_1 Q_1(u) \oplus w_2 Q_2(u)$ with

$$Q_1 = u_1 \oplus u_2 \oplus u_3 \oplus u_1u_3 \oplus u_2u_3 \oplus u_2u_4, \quad Q_2 = u_3 \oplus u_4 \oplus u_1u_2 \oplus u_1u_4 \oplus u_3u_4.$$

$w = (1,0)$

T	T	T	T
$T^\dagger$	T	$T^\dagger$	T
T	$T^\dagger$	$T^\dagger$	T
$T^\dagger$	$T^\dagger$	T	T

6 $T^\dagger$

$w = (0,1)$

T	$T^\dagger$	T	T
T	$T^\dagger$	T	T
$T^\dagger$	$T^\dagger$	T	$T^\dagger$
T	T	$T^\dagger$	T

6 $T^\dagger$

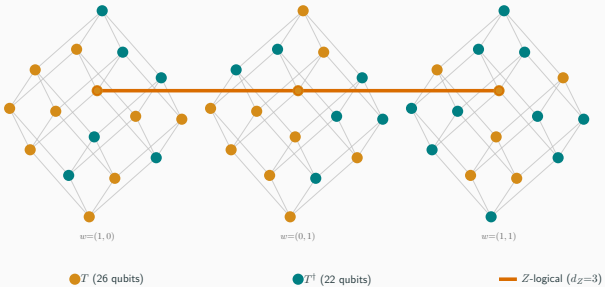
$w = (1,1)$

T	$T^\dagger$	$T^\dagger$	$T^\dagger$
$T^\dagger$	$T^\dagger$	T	$T^\dagger$
$T^\dagger$	T	T	T
$T^\dagger$	$T^\dagger$	T	$T^\dagger$

10 $T^\dagger$

Gold: T. Teal: $T^\dagger$. Rows u_1u_2, columns u_3u_4, both ordered $00, 01, 11, 10$.

The code $Q_{48} = [\![48, 3, 3]\!]$



Three 4-cubes (blocks $w = 10, 01, 11$). Gold: T. Teal: $T^\dagger$.

$d_X = 16$, $d_Z = 3$, native CCZ by $26\,T + 22\,T^\dagger$.

A weight-3 Z logical (orange): qubits $u = 0000$ in the three blocks.
Syndromes: w parts $10 \oplus 01 \oplus 11 = 00$, u parts zero.
Labels: $011 \oplus 110 \oplus 000 = 101 \neq 0$.
Projectivity gives $d_Z \geq 3$, so $d_Z = 3$.

Checked directly: all 8×64 codewords satisfy the phase condition.

Summary: known and open lengths

Three logical qubits, $d_Z \geq 3$, n physical qubits:

length	what is known
$n \leq 38$	no CSS code meets even the nine quasi-transversal conditions (this work)
$39 \leq n \leq 46$	open
$n = 47$	Jacinto et al. code meets the nine conditions but has no native pattern (this work)
$n = 48$	Q_{48} with native CCZ by $26\,T + 22\,T^\dagger$ (this work)
$n \geq 64$	a family on subspace complements with T on every qubit (this work)

Open: lengths 39 to 46, the largest d_X on a fixed support, other gates, and $k > 3$.

The gate conditions are overlap counts of rows. For Q_{48}: stabilizer rows from projective geometry, logical rows from SAT, signs from a $\mathbb{Z}_4$ linear system.

Why is 47 not native? Lower bound? All-T family? Sources

The nine conditions with index ranges

Question from slide 15: which rows enter each condition?

label	condition
K1	$\lvert K_i \rvert \equiv 0 \pmod 2$
K2	$\lvert K_i \wedge K_{i'} \rvert \equiv 0 \pmod 2$
K3	$\lvert K_1 \wedge K_2 \wedge K_3 \rvert \equiv 1 \pmod 2$
KS1	$\lvert K_i \wedge S_l \rvert \equiv 0 \pmod 2$
KS2	$\lvert K_i \wedge K_{i'} \wedge S_l \rvert \equiv 0 \pmod 2$
KS3	$\lvert K_i \wedge S_l \wedge S_{l'} \rvert \equiv 0 \pmod 2$
S1–S3	$\lvert S_l \rvert$, $\lvert S_l \wedge S_{l'} \rvert$, $\lvert S_l \wedge S_{l'} \wedge S_{l''} \rvert \equiv 0 \pmod 2$

Indices: $1 \le i < i' \le 3$ and $1 \le l < l' < l'' \le s$. K3 is the single odd parity.

Return to slide 15

Why FG48 has only weights 24 and 32

Question from slide 20: why only two weights, and why is FG48 unique?

The 48 columns occupy 48 of the 63 points of $\mathrm{PG}(5,2)$, missing 15. Each hyperplane has 31 points, so it meets the column set in at least $31-15=16$ and at most 31 points. 8-divisibility forces the section size $48-|c_a|$ to be a multiple of 8: 16 or 24, giving weights 32 or 24.

Count incidences: 63 hyperplanes, each of the 48 points on 31 of them:

$$N_{16}+N_{24}=63, \qquad 16N_{16}+24N_{24}=48\cdot 31 \quad\Longrightarrow\quad N_{16}=3,\ N_{24}=60.$$

Every projective 8-divisible $[48,6]$ code has this weight enumerator. The classification of projective 8-divisible codes of length at most 48 leaves only the solid complement.

Calderbank–Kantor 1986 Betsumiya–Munemasa 2012 Kurz 2021.

▸ Return to slide 20

Backup

The nine conditions do not imply native

Question from slide 25: why is the 47-qubit code not native?

Jacinto et al. give a $[\![47, 3, 3]\!]$ code with $d_X = 16$, $d_Z = 3$, $s = 6$, and projective support. It meets all nine conditions.

For it, the $\mathbb{Z}_4$ system of slide 23 has 47 unknowns and one equation per codeword. Elimination over $\mathbb{Z}_4$ shows it is inconsistent.

- No $T/T^\dagger$ pattern implements CCZ on this code.
- Any diagonal Clifford correction for $T^{\otimes 47}$ needs entangling CZ gates.

The smallest known code meeting the nine conditions has 47 qubits. The smallest known native code has 48.

Return to slide 25

Stabilizer conditions restrict the length

Question from slide 25: how does the lower bound work? Step 1: admissible lengths.

S1–S3 say: $\langle \chi_S, m \rangle = 0$ for every monomial m of degree 1 to 3. The dual of the Reed–Muller code $\mathrm{RM}(3, s)$ is $\mathrm{RM}(s-4, s)$. With δ_0 the indicator of the origin:

Admissible lengths (paper, Thm.)

S1–S3 hold iff $\chi_S \in \mathrm{RM}(s-4, s) + \langle \delta_0 \rangle$. The lengths are $n = |c| - c(0)$ for $c \in \mathrm{RM}(s-4, s)$ whose support spans $\mathbb{F}_2^s$.

s	code	weights ≤ 39	candidate $15 \leq n \leq 38$
5	$\mathrm{RM}(1,5)$	$16, 32$	$15, 16, 31$
6	$\mathrm{RM}(2,6)$	$16, 24, 28, 32, 36$	$15, 16, 23, 24, 27, 28, 31, 32, 35, 36$
7	$\mathrm{RM}(3,7)$	$16, 24, 28, 32, 36$	$15, 16, 23, 24, 27, 28, 31, 32, 35, 36$

▸ Next: the proof

Backup

No code below length 39

Theorem (length lower bound)

No CSS code with $k = 3$ and $d_Z \geq 3$ meets the nine conditions at $n \leq 38$, at any stabilizer rank s.

1. Make $\mathcal{C}_2$ projective and lower s while $2^s - 1 > n + \lfloor \binom{n}{2}/2 \rfloor$. At $n \leq 38$ this removes every $s \geq 9$.
2. $s \leq 5$: few admissible supports, all flats but one, and a direct search decides the last.
3. Supports that are affine flats of dimension at most 4 fail K3. This removes $n = 15, 16$.
4. $s = 6, 7, 8$: one support per affine-equivalence class of $c \in \mathrm{RM}(s-4, s)$, then an exact computer-assisted label search on each.

The bound covers quasi-transversal codes, so it covers native codes too.

Why one support per class? ▸ Return to slide 25

A family with all-T CCZ

Question from slide 25: which longer codes need no $T^\dagger$ at all?

Generalize FG48: delete a p-dimensional subspace from $\mathbb{F}_2^s$, $s = p + q$. The columns are $(u, w) \in \mathbb{F}_2^p \times \mathbb{F}_2^q$ with $w \neq 0$, and S has the coordinate rows.

$$K_1 = w_1 u_1 u_2, \qquad K_2 = w_1 u_3 u_4, \qquad K_3 = w_1 \Big(\prod_{i=5}^{p} u_i\Big)\Big(\prod_{j=2}^{q} w_j\Big).$$

Proposition (paper)

For $p \geq 4$, $q \geq 1$, $s \geq 7$: the nine conditions hold, $d_Z \geq 3$, and T **on every qubit** implements CCZ.

Length $n = 2^s - 2^p$. At $s = 7$: $n = 64, 96, 112$. The smallest member has $n = 64$.

Q_{48} has $s = 6$, below this family, and needs 22 $T^\dagger$ gates.

▸ Return to slide 25

Backup

Affine coordinate changes preserve the conditions

Question from the lower-bound proof: why is one support per affine-equivalence class enough?

Let A be an invertible binary $s \times s$ matrix and $t \in \mathbb{F}_2^s$, with arithmetic mod 2. The map $\beta \mapsto A\beta \oplus t$ sends the support of c to the support of $c'(\beta) = c(A\beta \oplus t)$.

- It permutes points, so it preserves weights and the Reed–Muller degree.
- A linear change A replaces S by AS up to column order. AS has the same row space $\mathcal{C}_2$.
- A translation t moves the origin. The paper therefore checks each translate $\mathcal{P}_a$ of a representative and its actual rank.

▸ Return to the proof

Sources

This work: B. Lu and K. R. Brown, *Building codes with transversal CCZ using projective geometry and SAT solvers* (in preparation). Reproduction guide: gate2code-public.

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Column indicator: Nezami–Haah, *Classification of small triorthogonal codes* (2022).

The 47-qubit code: Jacinto, Valcarce, Barizien, Gouzien, Sangouard, *Exploring the landscape of compact magic-state distillation factories* (2026).

Two-weight codes: Calderbank–Kantor, *The geometry of two-weight codes* (1986).

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